

EVIDENCE · SPATIAL · SERIES

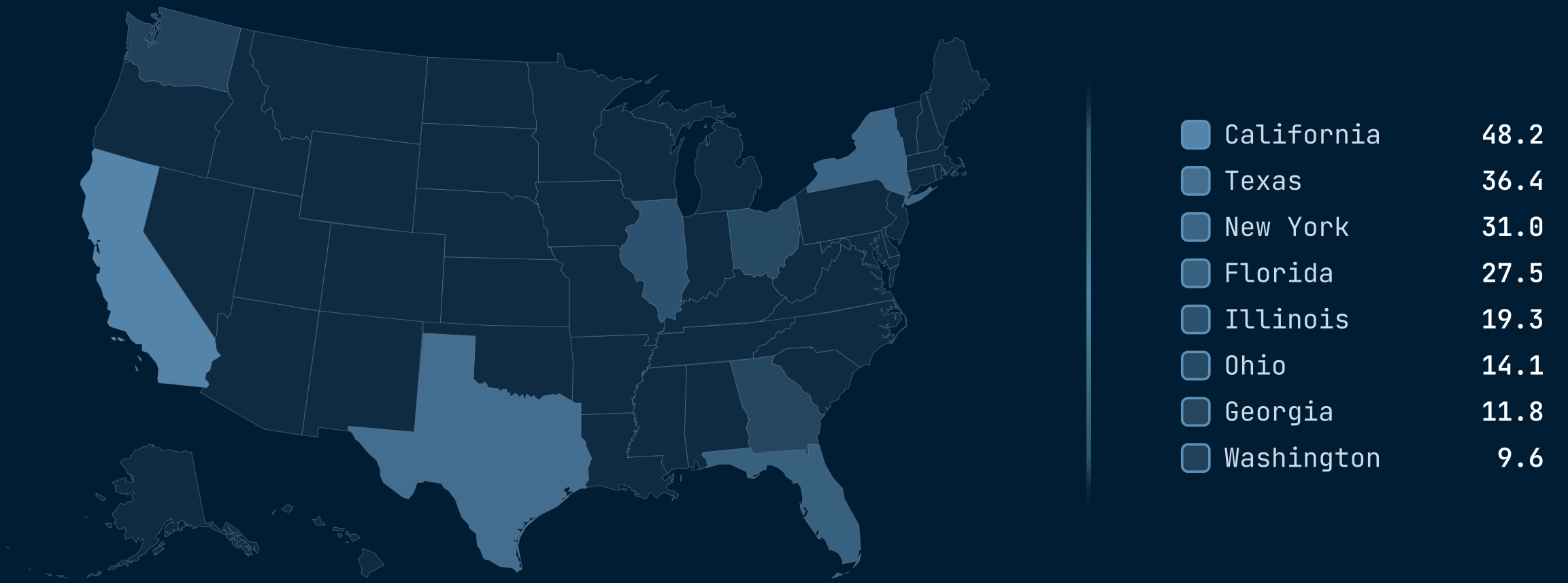
map

A world-countries (or US-states) basemap that fills regions by value (choropleth) or category (highlight) so the audience leaves knowing where.

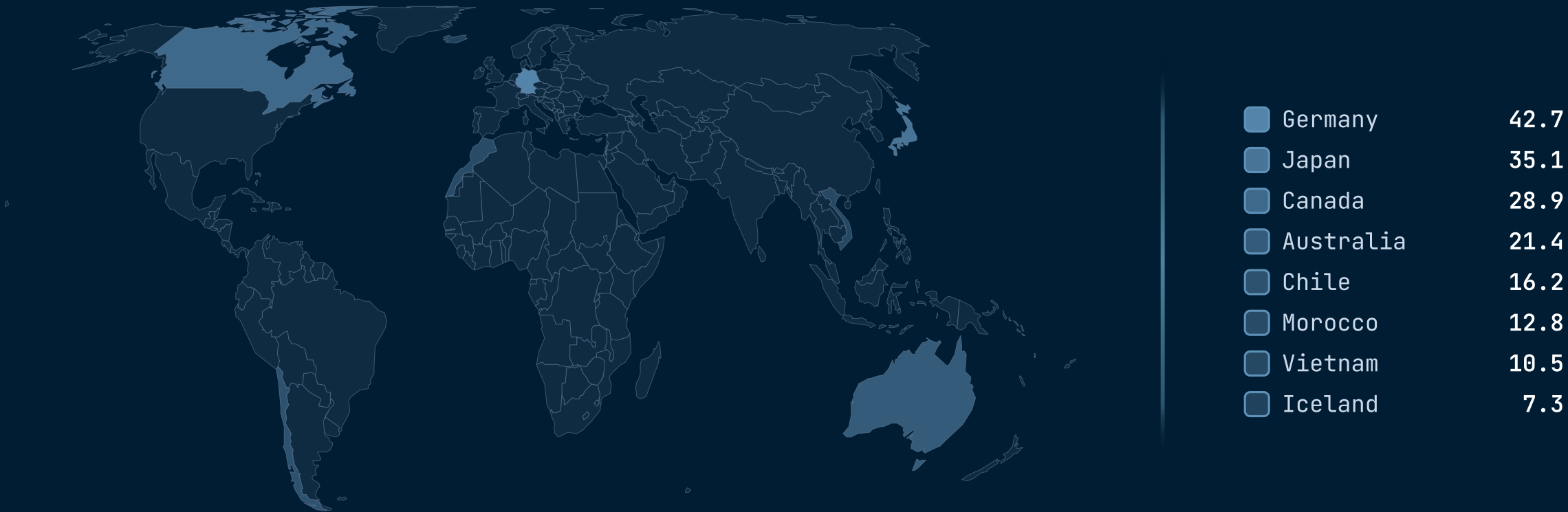
The map fills regions by value.



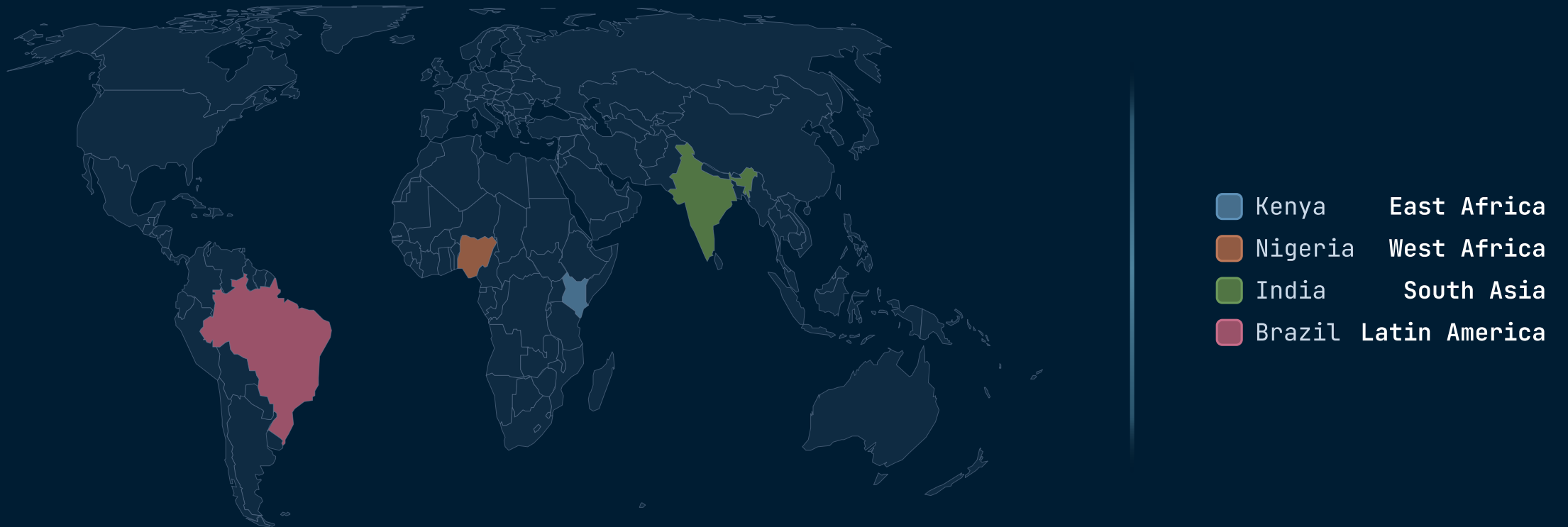
us swaps in the US-states basemap.



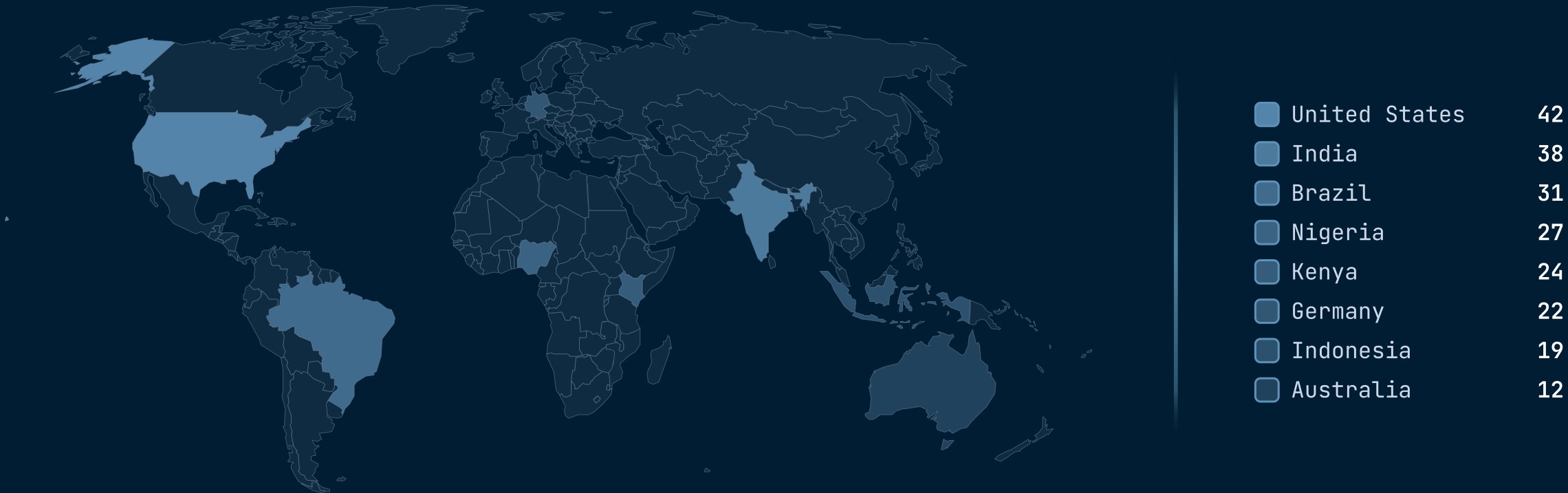
The same engine, pinned to the world basemap.



highlight fills by category, not value.



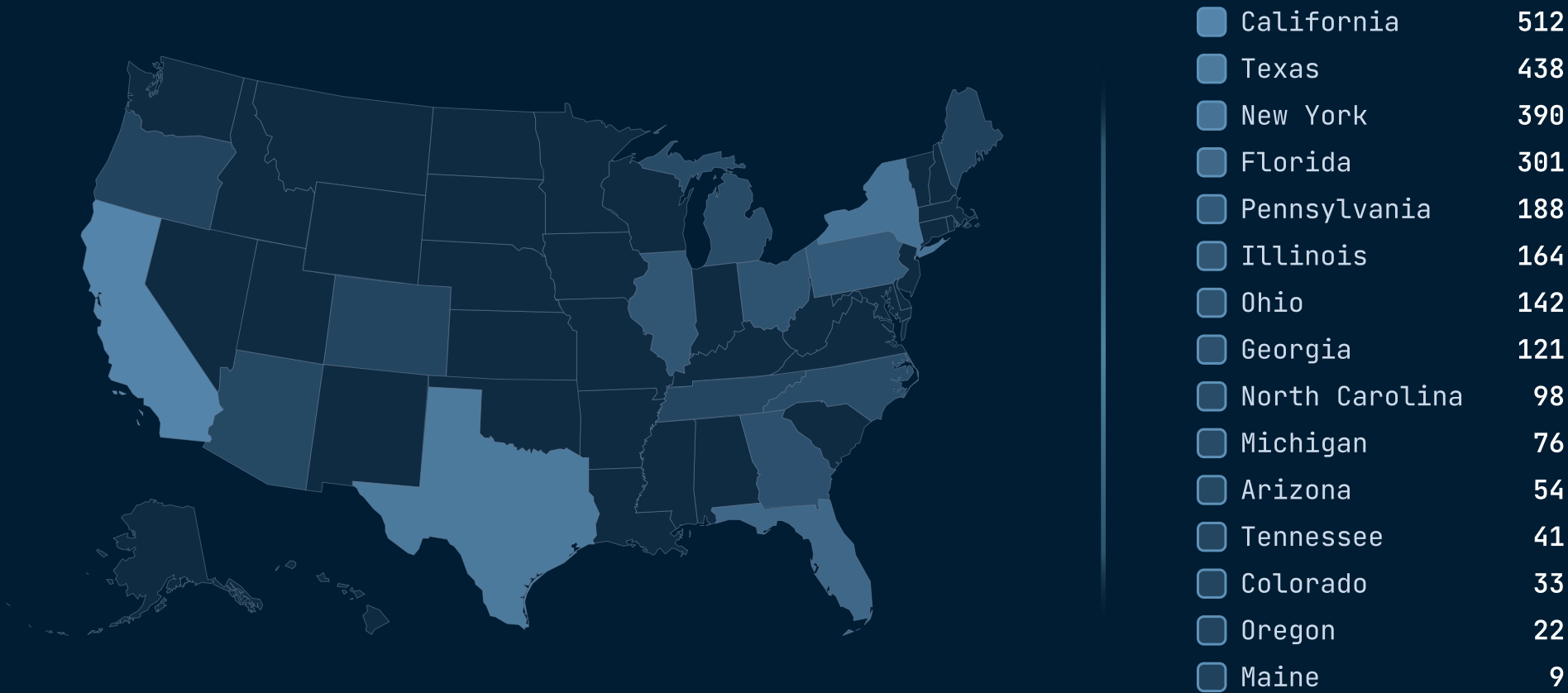
robinson swaps the projection.



grouped fills whole blocs at once.



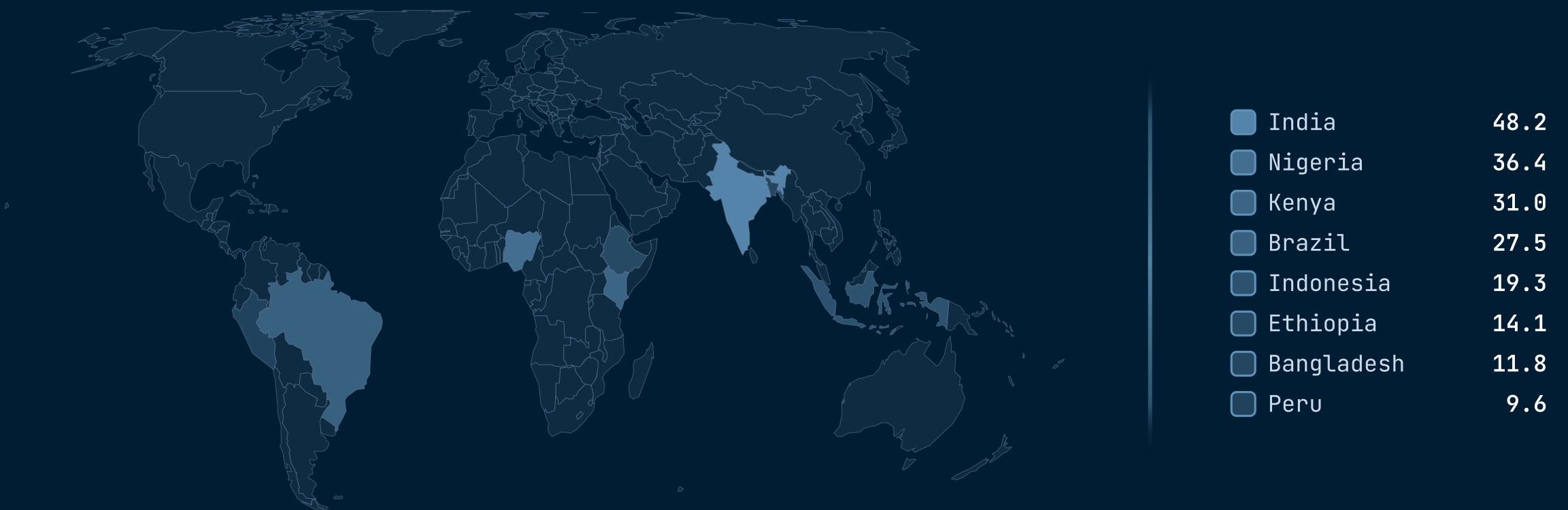
A wide spread across fifteen states.



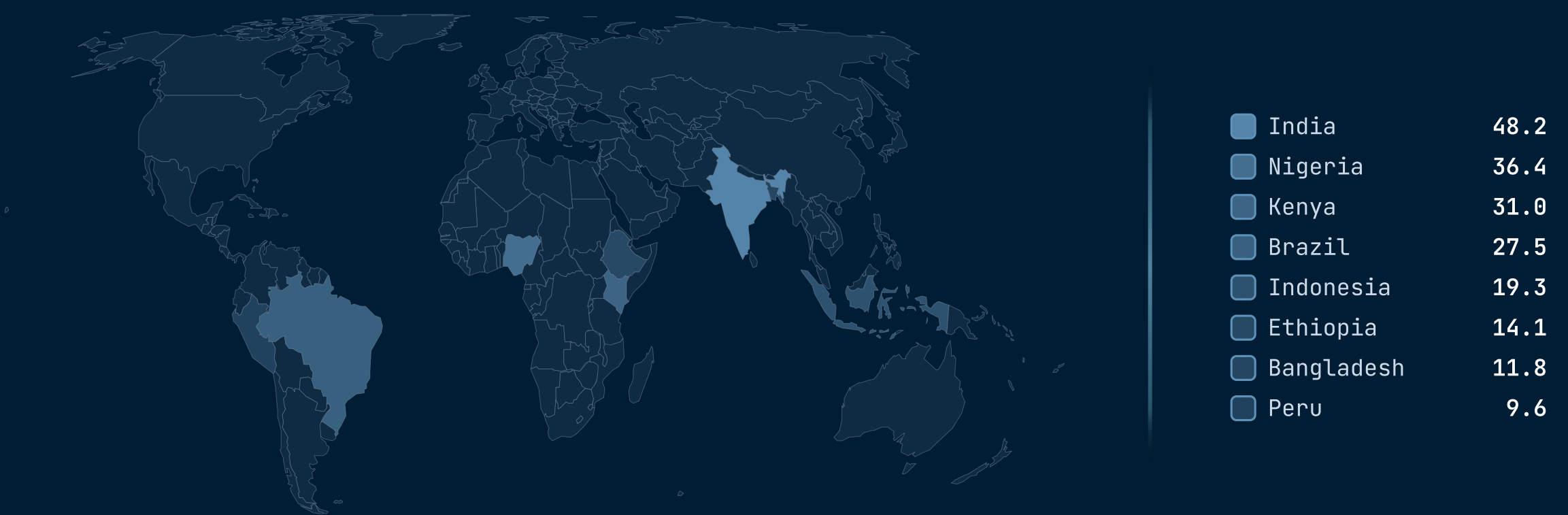
The map fills regions by value.



The map fills regions by value.



The map fills regions by value.



When NOT to reach for map.

A map as decoration

If the regions aren't the comparison — you just want a US-shaped graphic behind some numbers — drop the basemap. An `image` scrim or a `stats` row carries headline figures without implying the geography is the message.

Too many shades to read

A choropleth past a dozen distinct values asks the eye to rank colors it can't separate. Bucket the values, switch to `highlight` for a categorical read, or lead with a `progress` ranking and keep the map as support.

Sub-region precision the basemap doesn't have

The basemaps draw US states and world countries — not counties, districts, sub-national regions, or city pins, and the world cut (110m) omits the smallest city-states. If the story lives below that line, a labeled `image` of the real map serves better than forcing it onto the basemap.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`progress` — the regions are really a ranking — labeled bars compare magnitudes faster than shades

`stats` — a few headline figures with no geography to place them on

`piechart` — regional shares of a single whole rather than a value per place

`image` — the geography needs detail (counties, cities, routes) the basemap can't draw